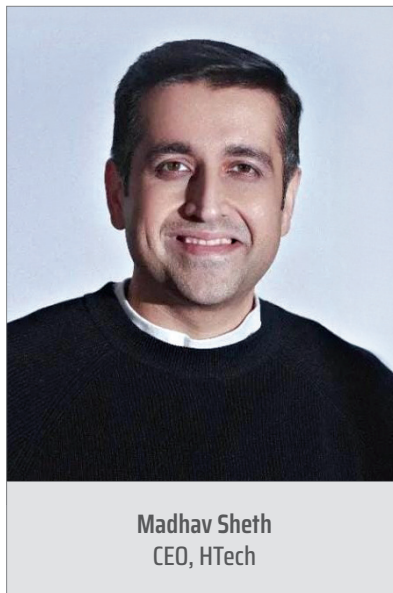


# Capturing the rugged smartphone market

“Trust, Reliability and Peace of Mind sums up the HONOR X9b”, says **Madhav Sheth**, CEO, HTech

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**H**Tech has launched the HONOR X9b which is the second smartphone in the company's portfolio since its return to India. The phone touts exceptional durability with a five-star certification from SGS (Switzerland) to back it up. I struck up a conversation with HTech CEO, Madhav Sheth, to learn more about HONOR's latest smartphone in India and how it plans to set itself apart from its competition. We even talked about HTech's entry into the AIOT space with the HONOR CHOICE Earbuds X5 (review) and the HONOR CHOICE Watch.



Madhav Sheth  
CEO, HTech

**Digit:** H-Tech seems to be gunning hard for the durability factor in its smartphones in India, first with the Honor 90 and now with the Honor X9B. So is this an area you find lacking in the Indian smartphone market that H-Tech can capture?

**Madhav Sheth:** We need to understand two things. The value of the market in India is below ₹25,000, which means that 90 per cent of phones sold in India would be below ₹30,000. So if that is the data, roughly. And we launched Honor 90, which was between ₹30,000 and ₹40,000. So the segment where we were trying to create the niche, but we wanted to showcase the technology that Honor

can bring to the table. This time we want to make sure that probably we hit the belly of the market and bring the technology at a more affordable price for the masses.

**Digit:** So do you find this area lacking in other companies in India that they don't give so much attention to durability?

**Madhav Sheth:** Definitely yes, I would not say probably but definitely yes because what they are focusing on is all the marketing gimmicks. They are just changing the back panel but all the specs are almost the same. They are focusing on fast charging where fast charging is one of the aspects to

reduce your anxiety but not completely take it away.

The other thing which people get anxious about is when the screen can get damaged by objects. The other thing which people are worried about is eye safety. Because people are spending too much time on the screen. So what is more important for your health? What is more important for your day-to-day well-being? Is it having no anxiety about charging?

With the HONOR X9B, I'm giving you almost a 6,000 mAh battery with a slimminess of 7.9 and 8 mm. If you look in the industry, every other 5,000 mAh battery would have a minimum size of around 8.5 or 8.7 mm. This is a 6,000 mAh battery with 7.9 and 8 mm thickness. which is good to hold, lighter in weight, which is 185 grams, and very easy to carry. That's what we are focusing on.

**Digit:** So the Honor X9B uses something dubbed as the Honor cushioning material to increase the drop resistance. Can you give us some insight into some of the materials you used or how it's been fused?

**Madhav Sheth:** Honor has a 3-layer protection in terms of display. And this 3-layer protection is extremely important. This is called sealant injection technology. It pushes the cushion around the corner, in the centre and as well as the top, all on the three sides. And the most important thing, it gives you a water resistance of IPX5 and IPX8. IPX8 on the sides, IPX5 in the centre. This phone has been tested by SGS and certified as one of the best phones during the drop test by SGS from all 10 sides. And that's something that makes it extremely viable for Indian consumers who are always on the go.

**Digit:** Have you all done any kind of outlandish tests on the Honor X9B within Honor itself? And what is probably the most extreme test